

Question:

At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

Answer Choices:

- A. visual system
- B. thalamus
- C. frontal lobe
- D. brain stem
- E. parietal lobe
- F. cerebellum
- G. cortex
- H. basal ganglia
- I. hypothalamus
- J. limbic system

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

Answer : G . cortex

Explanation ( concise ):

- The cerebral cortex , including its six layers , is largely immature at birth . Cortical synapses and connectivity ( especially long -range “horizontal” associations ) develop postnatally through experience -dependent pruning and myelination .
- In contrast , subcortical structures such as the thalamus , hypothalamus , basal ganglia , brain stem , and cerebellum have functional rudiments present at birth ( e.g ., vital reflex arcs , tone regulation , early motor coordination ), even though they continue to mature .
- Sensory systems ( visual , auditory ) show early functional beginnings ; while the visual system is relatively underdeveloped at birth , it is not the least developed overall in terms of gross neural structure and functional integration .
- The limbic system has early organizing influences , especially the hippocampus for memory traces , but its systems -level functional maturation advances more than the cortex in the first weeks of life .

Therefore , the least developed part of the brain at birth is the cortex .

Correct answer : G . cortex

</think>

< answer >

G . cortex

</answer>